

For consumers in metro cities, Panasonic has launched TVs supporting Skype, YouTube and Picasa. The 50V20 plasma TV priced at Rs 125,000 is one example.

The Samsung LED TV lineup includes 13 models in 56cm (22-inch) to 140cm (55-inch) screen sizes, priced between Rs 25,000 and Rs 200,000.

Which is preferable?

"The choice between LCD, LED and plasma TVs will vary depending on the prioritisation between various criteria like contrast ratios, power consumption, eco-friendliness, screen size of TV required, thinness desired or cost of the TV itself," says K. Sriram, VP, sales, marketing and services, Mirc Electronics-ONIDA.

At present, if you see the market trend, LCD TVs are the most preferred of the lot. LED TVs are not selling much because of their high prices. However, their prices are expected to come down in a year or so. Plasma TVs, on the other hand, are suitable for consumers wanting screen size above 107 cm (42 inches) and for commercial applications like presentations.

What are 3-D TVs?

If you want to enjoy life-like experience of movies, sports and games, and have enough money to spend for that, buy a 3-D TV. It will give you ultimate viewing experience by liberating

content from the flat confines of the TV and turning it into explosive imagery. The effect is breathtaking—life-enriching, ultra-real picture quality. A 3-D TV will give you a theatre-like feel right at your home, but, as I said before, you should be ready to pay a hefty amount for it.

Most people are familiar with the old anaglyph method of 3-D technology. The 3-D glasses we wore to watch 3-D movies were based on the red-blue polarisation of the picture. Basically, your right eye saw an image through a blue filter, and your left eye saw a slightly different image (from a different angle) through a red filter. The brain put these two images together like it normally does, and the 3-D sensation was delivered. The result seen by the viewer was discoloured and usually lower-resolution than the new method.

The technology being used in today's 3-D TVs enables such improvements as full colour and high resolution—reportedly full 1080p HD resolution for both eyes.

3-D glasses used are not based on red/blue filters, but on shutter actions. The shutter speed is synchronised in such a way that your right eye sees the images meant for the right eye only, and the left eye sees the images meant for the left eye only. The brain processes both images to form the 3-D image. This type of 'active' or 'shutter' glasses are more expensive.

3-D technology is available in all of LCD, LED and plasma TVs but most of the brands are focusing on 3-D in LED TVs. 3-D TVs show you 3-D picture if the content is recorded in 3-D. Currently, some companies are offering 3-D LCD/LED/plasma TVs with 2-D/3-D conversion technology, which provide a 3-D experience that is not as good as with original 3-D content. Also, these sets cost more than the normal 2-D TV.

As 3-D TV technology is in the evolving stage, currently, these TVs cost 100 to 125 per cent more than the normal 2-D TVs.

Sony has recently introduced HX, NX & LX series of 3-D LED TVs at a starting price of Rs 123,900. Packed with latest features, its slim BRAVIA HX800 series TV is claimed to deliver high contrast levels and vibrant colours. BRAVIA Engine 3 fully digital video processor helps it to produce superb picture quality with reduced visual noise, enhanced colours and overall image detail even on 1080p sources.

Panasonic has come out with 127cm (50-inch) and 165cm (65-inch) models of 3-D TVs.

LG claims its new 3-D line-up combines superb design, latest technology and superior performance. It comes loaded with features like Netcast, DLNA, Bluetooth and wireless connectivity option.

With ten television models across three technology platforms of LED, LCD and plasma, and screen sizes ranging from 102 cm (40 inches) to 160 cm (63 inches), Samsung too has a large lineup of 3-D TVs. Its 3-D LCD series is available in 117cm (46-inch) and 140cm (55-inch) screen sizes, priced between Rs 129,000 and Rs 186,900, respectively. The 160cm 3-D plasma TV is priced at Rs 300,000. The 9000 series of Full HD 3-D LED TV, which is ultra-sleek (7.98mm thin) with a built-in tuner and has a touchscreen remote control with display, is available in 140cm screen size, priced at Rs 440,000.

Videocon claims that its 3-D TVs have the advantages of excellent reali-

Panasonic TH-P50VT20D

Features

- FULL HD 3-D plasma with 3-D Eyewear included
- Screen size 127cm (50-inch) diagonal
- Infinite Black Pro with dynamic contrast 5,000,000:1
- 600Hz sub-field drive & 1080 line moving picture resolution
- VIERA CAST with Skype
- THX certified display
- 4 HDMI inputs

